

MCQ Teacher Guide

Building and running assessments on MCQ

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1. Getting started

MCQ is a place to write multiple-choice and short-answer assessments, assign them to your students, and see how everyone did. This guide covers everything a teacher needs.

Signing in

The sign-in page has two sides. Use the left panel, Teachers & administrators. Students use the right panel. If you sign in on the wrong side the page will tell you and point you to the other one.

Signing in with Google from the teacher panel creates your teacher account straight away - there is no approval queue and nothing to wait for. You can also sign in with an email and password if an administrator set one up for you.

Note: Anyone can create a teacher account. Students, by contrast, must choose at least one teacher before they can do anything, so your students will need to find you by name or email.

2. Your roster

Your roster is the list of students you teach. Only students on your roster can be assigned your assessments, and only their results appear in your analytics.

How students join you

1. A student signs in for the first time and is asked to choose a teacher.
2. They search for you by name or email and select you.
3. They appear on your roster immediately, and pick up any assessment you had already assigned to the whole class.

Adding students yourself

Open Students to add someone directly. Add an existing student to roster finds a student who already has an account. Add a new student creates the account from their name and email.

Note: A student you create this way has no password yet, so they will need to sign in with Google using that same email address.

Teams

Teams are named groups inside your roster - a class period, a set, a study group. Once a team exists you can assign a whole assessment to it in one click. Manage members from the Students page.

3. Building an assessment

Choose Create quiz. The page has two tabs: Quiz settings and Questions. You can move between them freely; nothing is lost until you publish or leave the page.

Quiz settings

- Quiz title - what students see on their dashboard.
- Time allowed - the countdown each student gets once they press Start. It runs from their own start time, not the clock.
- Passing score - the percentage needed to pass.
- Allow retakes - lets a student take the assessment more than once. Off by default.
- Show class average to students - reveals the class average alongside their own result.
- Randomize question order and Randomize answer order - shuffle per student, so neighbours do not see the same paper. True/False options are never shuffled.
- Opening and closing date and time - when the assessment is visible. Turn either off to leave that end open.

Note: Times are entered and shown in your own local time zone.

Audience

Assign to All gives the assessment to everyone currently on your roster, and to anyone who joins you later. Choose Students or Teams to be more specific.

Publishing

Press Publish quiz. If anything is missing - an untitled quiz, a question with no text, a correct answer that is not one of the options - the page lists exactly what to fix and nothing is saved.

4. Question types

Every question has a type, chosen from the dropdown above it.

Multiple choice

Up to four options, A to D, with exactly one correct answer. Leave an option blank to offer fewer than four; you need at least two.

Multiple choice - select all that apply

Same options, but the student picks any number of them. It is marked right only when their selection matches yours exactly - no partial credit.

True / False

Two fixed options. Pick which one is correct.

Fill in the blank and Short answer

The student types their answer into a box instead of picking from a list. The two behave identically; use whichever name reads better in your question. See the next section for how they are marked.

5. How typed answers are marked

Typed questions are marked automatically. Each one has an Answer type - Text or Number - which decides how forgiving the marking is.

Number answers

Use Number whenever the answer is a quantity. The system compares values, not characters, so 6, 6.0, 6.00, +6 and $12/2$ are all the same answer.

How precise the student must be is taken from how precisely you wrote the answer:

- Write a whole number, such as 6, and only that exact value is accepted. 6.5 and 7 are wrong.
- Write 33.33 and anything within 0.005 is accepted - so 33.33, 33.333 and $100/3$ all pass, while 33.3 does not.
- Write 2.5 and anything within 0.05 is accepted.

In short: the number of decimal places you type is the precision you are asking for. As you type, the line under the answer box shows the exact range that will be accepted, so you can check before publishing.

If you want a wider window, set Accept answers within under Marking options. For example, an answer of 100 with a tolerance of 5 accepts anything from 95 to 105.

Students see a matching hint under their answer box - Enter a whole number, or Round to 2 decimal places - so nobody has to guess.

Text answers

Capitals, surrounding spaces and trailing punctuation are always ignored, so paris, Paris and "Paris." all match Paris.

- Also accept - a comma-separated list of other answers you will take, for example USA, US, America.
- Forgive single-letter spelling slips - accepts an answer that is one letter away from the right one. It only applies to answers of four letters or more, so short answers are never guessed at.

Keeping the answer box sensible

The answer box is sized automatically from your answer - a two-digit number gets a small box. Set Limit the answer box to under Marking options to cap it yourself, which is a simple way to stop students writing an essay where a number belongs.

Note: Students never receive the correct answer in the page. Typed answers are marked on the server.

6. Uploading a question bank

Instead of typing questions one at a time you can upload a .txt or .docx file. Open a quiz, choose Manage, then Upload question bank.

Format the file with numbered questions, lettered options, and an answer key at the end:

- 1. What does CPU stand for?
- A. Central Processing Unit
- B. Computer Personal Utility
- ...
- Answer Key: 1: A, 2: B, 3: A

After reading the file you get a table of everything it found. Check it, change any question's Type - including to a typed answer - and press Save question bank and publish. Questions without a matching answer key entry are left out.

7. Assigning, scheduling and results

Changing who gets an assessment

Open Manage on a quiz, then Assign by students or teams. You can switch between All, specific students, and teams at any time.

While students are working

Analytics shows every student's status on a given exam - Not started, In progress or Completed - along with their score and last activity. The same table appears under Manage.

Note: Once a real student starts an assessment its settings - timing, passing score, retakes - become read-only. Your own preview attempts from Student view do not count.

Questions can still be corrected while students are working, and nothing changes under anyone silently. A student whose paper no longer matches is told so, and their Submit button waits until they load your change; their answers so far are kept and carried across. A student who has saved and left picks the new version up when they press Resume.

Note: Correcting an answer key is the exception, because there is nothing for the student to see. Attempts are marked against the key as it stands when they are handed in, so the correction simply applies. Attempts already submitted keep their old marks until you use Regrade submitted attempts.

Downloads

- Download PDF - the paper itself, optionally with the answer key and the quiz settings.
- Download results CSV - every assigned student with status, score and result.
- Download question bank CSV and Download printable DOCX - for editing or handing out on paper.

8. Previewing and troubleshooting

Student view shows the workspace exactly as a student sees it, and lets you take your own assessments to check they read correctly. These attempts are excluded from your analytics.

Common questions

- A student cannot see my assessment - check they are on your roster, that the quiz is assigned to them, and that the opening time has passed and the closing time has not.
- A student ran out of time - their answers are submitted automatically when the timer reaches zero, and whatever they had answered is marked.
- I need to fix a published question - open Manage, edit it, and save. Students partway through are told and can pick the correction up without losing their answers; anyone who has already submitted is re-marked by Regrade submitted attempts.
- A student joined the wrong teacher - they can leave you from My teachers, and you can remove them from your roster.